Day 66 (stop 2 of 2) - Rural Rocks, Obese

Bruce Trail side-trail plan (dog-friendly, max ~8 mi) · Peninsula section · hike 87 · Rural Rocks, west of Wiarton

4.3 km / 2.7 mi	~1.6 h	4.2 km new	178 min
total walking	hiking, plus stops	side trail covered	drive from home, Sat 7 am

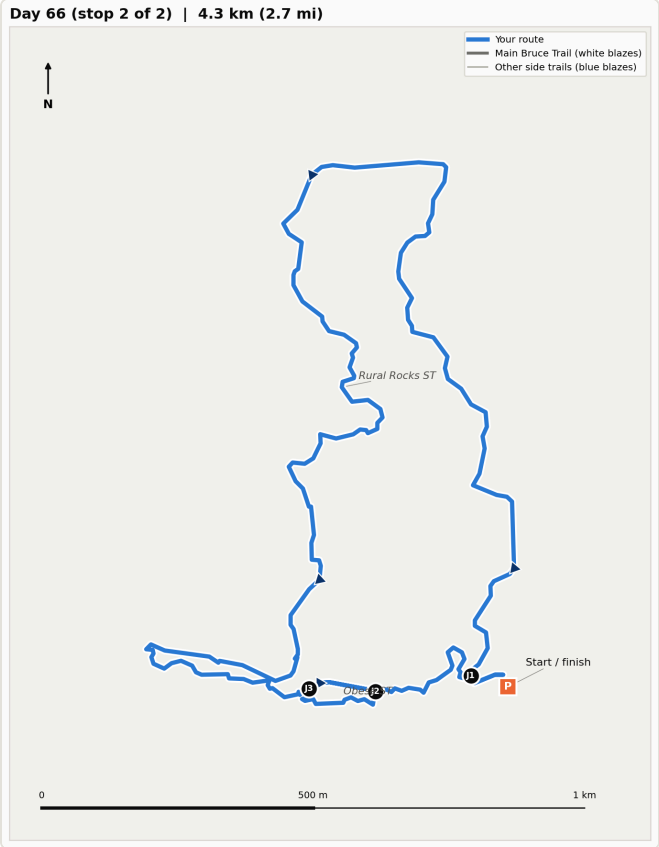
Park (P): From Wiarton, take Bruce Rd 13 west for 2 km to Northacres Rd. Parking and access to the trail is 30 m north of the intersection. Google Maps. **Free**

Navigate: import *day66b_hike087.gpx* into Gaia GPS. The track is the whole route in walking order, and the J waypoints match the directions below.

Side trails covered: Rural Rocks Side Trail (4.0 km); Obese Side Trail (0.2 km)

Same day: this is stop 2 of 2 on day 66 (5.2 mi of hiking, about 359 min total driving). Other stop(s): stop 1: hike 86, 2.5 mi from Off road parking at the end of Bayview Street.

Route map



What to expect

- **Parking:** From Wiarton, take Bruce Rd 13 west for 2 km to Northacres Rd. Parking and the trail access are 30 m north of the intersection.
- **Rural Rocks Side Trail:** A blue-blazed loop, followed clockwise in Ontario Nature Trails' description. It's rated difficult, on natural and rocky ground. It starts among large rocks left from an ancient glacial lake shoreline. Then it runs through maple, balsam and birch forest, past beaver ponds, and along a ridge with views.
- **Footing:** Expect uneven ground through the boulder area, and possible wet spots near the beaver ponds. Allow extra time for a 4 km loop.
- **Obese Side Trail:** A very short spur off the loop. We found no description of it.

Parking options

No other official Bruce Trail parking lies within about 1 km of this route. If you need to stop early, turn back the way you came; the GPS track records what you covered, and the website shows what is left.

Parking costs were checked in October 2026 from operator websites and Bruce Trail Conservancy data; prices and booking rules change, so check before you go.

Turn-by-turn

km	mi	Directions
0.0	0.0	Start at the parking: From Wiarton, take Bruce Rd 13 west for 2 km to Northacres Rd. Head west on the blue-blazed Rural Rocks Side Trail.
0.1	0.0	J1: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the Rural Rocks Side Trail, heading west. (the blue-blazed Rural Rocks Side Trail goes off on your right.)
0.4	0.2	J2: Turn left onto the blue-blazed Obese Side Trail, heading south-west. (the blue-blazed Rural Rocks Side Trail goes off ahead.)
0.6	0.4	J3: Turn right onto the blue-blazed Rural Rocks Side Trail, heading east. (the blue-blazed Rural Rocks Side Trail goes off on your left.)

0.7	0.4	J2: Turnaround point. Turn around and retrace your steps.
0.8	0.5	J3: Junction. Continue straight to stay on the Rural Rocks Side Trail, heading west. (the Obese Side Trail you already walked goes off on your left.)
4.2	2.6	J1: Junction. Turn sharp left to stay on the Rural Rocks Side Trail, heading east. (the Rural Rocks Side Trail you already walked goes off on your right.)
4.3	2.7	Back at the parking. Hike complete.

Distances and junctions are computed from the Bruce Trail Conservancy's trail data (Bruce County GIS). Left/right is calculated from the trail geometry. Use it as a guide, follow the blazes, and check the Conservancy's trail-change notices before you go. Dogs must be leashed everywhere on the Bruce Trail. Trail descriptions draw on Ontario Nature Trails.